

experience. “Really, it’s important to think about what the user feels about the application after he or she is done using it. Is he or she thinking ‘Geez, that was tough, thank God I got through that’, or is it closer to ‘Wow that was quick, I wish I could do more through this app’”, says Sean Mahoney, president and CEO of mobile app development company AndPlus. If you’ve written highly optimised code but have not paid attention to how a user will interact with the application, it will fail. Developers must have design interface skills in addition to technical knowledge. In India, coding is not the differentiator. Multi touch, pinch to zoom, gesture recognition and accelerometers are trends app developers must keep in mind to make the experience richer, enticing and exciting. The underlying technology is a mere tool while the developer’s expertise is a basic requirement.

Pay scales and career path

Pay scales in app development companies are a little higher than those of IT professionals from other backgrounds such as Java or .Net, simply because of current demand. iPhone and Android developers are more preferred right now. By and large, freshers can expect to make anywhere between 2.5 to 3 lakhs.

“Most of the IT companies in India have Mobile Software departments and the exploding Smartphone market is a big opportunity for everyone. On an average anyone with one year of experience in iPhone or Android gets anywhere from Rs. 25,000 to Rs. 35,000 per month”, said Sushant Das, CTO of The Porting Lab. “Candidates are expected to pick up languages and programming concepts through their formal education course but not so much the actual working on development tools.”

From a fresher’s hiring standpoint we check analytical ability and algorithm making ability at entry point,” added Siddharth from RapidSoft. Companies depending on their size can take candidates who have trained with, say, Aptech or NIIT, or depending on their hiring guidelines insist on Engineering/M.CA degrees. On hiring freshers, companies put them through about six months of training, in which they’re made conversant with the different platforms and technologies. In RapidSoft the career path goes something like this – Junior Developer > Program Lead > Team Lead > Project/Delivery Manager. The position of Project Manager can be attained in about 10 years, and once in this position you can hope to conservatively draw Rs.14-17 lakhs. The sky is the limit.